

Nomination ID: 9455

Nominator's Name: Carrie Kidd (ckidd@harmonyforhopewv.org)

Nominee's Name: Harmony for Hope Inc.

How do you know this person?

Harmony for Hope, Inc. was founded in 2011 and has operated continuously since, stewarding the Historic Walking Trail and the Fayette County Community Arts Center in Mount Hope, WV. In 2017, the organization became a founding partner in building the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail, working in coalition with the National Park Service, the Conservation Fund, and local organizations committed to telling Mount Hope's story. That trail work has continued for nearly a decade, growing into partnerships with the City of Thurmond, WVU, and New River Gorge National Park and Preserve. These relationships have been built through sustained, largely volunteer-driven presence in the community rather than short-term project funding.

**How has this person or organization gone above and beyond to support your community?
Please provide specific examples or personal anecdotes.**

Harmony for Hope keeps Mount Hope's shared history and creative life active on almost no budget. Its founding role in the 1.25-mile Historic Walking Trail — built in coalition with the National Park Service and the Conservation Fund — connects sixteen points of architectural and cultural significance through town. At the Fayette County Community Arts Center, steps from the trailhead, the organization hosts a resident artist who works directly with residents, keeping the space open to the community it serves. None of this is required of a nonprofit with such limited resources; it happens because Mount Hope's shared story has been treated as worth sustaining for close to a decade, independent of grant cycles.

What examples or personal stories can you share about how this person or organization has created the space or opportunity for meaningful relationships to develop in your community?

In 2017, Harmony for Hope became a founding partner in building the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail, working alongside the National Park Service, the Conservation Fund, and local organizations who believed Mount Hope's story deserved to be told. That partnership has continued for nearly a decade: in June 2026, New River Gorge National Park and Preserve's Acting Superintendent, Bryan Wender, wrote in support of the organization's latest heritage and connectivity work, citing the park's \$94 million annual contribution to gateway communities and the shared responsibility of preserving Thurmond's cultural resources for visitors and youth. That an NPS superintendent continues to engage directly with a small, largely volunteer-run nonprofit nearly ten years into the relationship reflects the kind of sustained trust weaving is built on, not a single grant cycle.